

A FLIPKART SPOKESPERSON ON BUYING ONLINE

What's with the exclusive launches?

What sort of insights (on consumer behaviour, data) do brands demand for such campaigns?

Brands, while launching their products online, understand the reach and credibility of the platform. We also believe that the kind of reach a brand can get from an online player like Flipkart is unparalleled. Added to this is the immense amount of customer data we have access to given our 26 million registered users. While we are extremely strict about maintaining the data of our customers at all times, we are also in a unique position to be able to tell brands and sellers what kind of products and prices work for our



customers. We are able to provide granular data on market trends, fast-moving offers and product combinations, etc. This also helps our sellers work out demographic specific marketing campaigns and create a larger impact during their launches. We are always exploring associations with brands and sellers across categories that can be beneficial to not only the sellers, but our customers as well— offering them the widest range at the best prices.

Does COD work in India?

COD has worked very well with Indian consumers. Indian consumers are much more cautious about shopping online as compared to the West. They are reluctant to divulge credit card details. The cash on delivery service has helped a lot of traditional consumers turn to online shopping. Also, the model has unlocked a whole new customer base which

hadn't been exposed to the benefits of plastic or is apprehensive about it. Flipkart's focus on customer satisfaction and ownership of the customer experience has led us to really drive COD amongst our shoppers, helping them get access to the benefits of online shopping without compromising their need for security in online transactions.

Give us a sense of the percentage split between mobile vs non-mobile users?

Mobile is where we will see the next wave of online shoppers coming from. The attraction of being able to shop on the go, no matter where you are or whether you have access to a PC, is what's driving the m-commerce surge. The potential for growth, given the country's huge population, is massive. In fact, nearly half of Flipkart's sales are being driven by mobile. A report by Boston Consulting Group noted that at present around 45% of online consumers in India use only their mobile devices to access the Internet. This is expected to increase to 60% over the next three years. Given these statistics, any online player looking to tap into an emerging market needs to work towards a 'mobile first' strategy. M-commerce will be the focus area for most online shopping companies this year. Increased smartphone penetration means that a greater section of our target audience is accessing our sites through their internet-enabled mobile phones and we aim to keep working on our apps and tailor-made sites to capture this base. We have already launched native apps across all mobile platforms and special offers to encourage customers to shop through mobiles. We have teams working on enhancing the mobile commerce experience at Flipkart, ensuring that it matches, if not surpasses, the desktop experience. Flipkart, in our view, is slated to become an m-commerce based marketplace.

will this help you keep track of all your transactions but you can also have points gathered in one place. These credit card usage points can come in handy over time if you divert your daily grocery and fuel costs on to this card as well. The points can be used for an assortment of things, depending on the credit card provider, such as free gadgets or vacations. Do a

careful study of which credit card works best for you.

Secure Browsing

A basic add-on security trick is to do all your shopping in a freshly opened browser window. It even helps to have a separate browser but that might be overkill. Keeping the surfing browsers sepa-

rate from shopping browsers has proven to be more secure due to a lack of vulnerability to online malware in the shopping sessions. Always remember, with money you can never be too careful. It's also a good habit to log-out of your shopping session once done and close the window. Also getting into the habit of purging the cookies on your browser will help make it more secure for financial transactions. Another good habit is to be on the look out for URL information when transitioning between pages while shopping. All transactions take place on a secure page with "https" as a signifier. Sometime malicious programs or people can force redirect payments away from the secure servers and the URL of the payment page isn't authentic. Reading the URL carefully can further help in securing you against outsider fraud.

Tools of the Trade: The Fun Bits

You would never think that supercomputers would be used to help shopping – but you'd be wrong. The grand-daddy of the computer industry – IBM – has already begun adapting its Watson supercomputer to function as a digital personal shopper for online shopping. The way it would be used is as we would dream it to function – ask for what you want and it finds it for you. Saw an awesome pair of shoes – share the picture on your device and the assistant finds you the websites it's available on. The American Internet shopping site Zappos has even launched Ask Zappos which performs the services of a personal shopper, even if the product isn't available on the Zappos website. In India however we still haven't reached that pinnacle of customer service.

Here, There Be Deals

The simplest and essential service that helps in smart shopping is the use of price comparison applications and websites. These websites scour the many shopping portals on the Internet and serve as a search engine for all the products available. Since the price difference between websites can turn into great savings, these websites save you the trouble of having to check all of them yourself. You just need to type in what you want and you can see the prices and websites where it's available. Presto! You have a deal!